

Ndapa Nakashole

Employment History

- July 2023–Now **Associate Professor**, *University of California, San Diego, CA*
Jan 2017–2023 **Assistant Professor**, *University of California, San Diego, CA*
2013–2016 **Postdoctoral Fellow**, *Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA*
Summer 2011 **Intern**, *Microsoft Research, Redmond, WA*
Mar–Aug 2008 **Intern**, *IBM Zurich Research, Switzerland*

Education

- 2009–2012 **Ph.D. in Computer Science (Summa cum laude)**, *Max Planck Institute for Informatics & Saarland University, Germany*
Advisor: Gerhard Weikum
2002–2009 **B.Sc (2005), B.Sc Honors (2006, First Class) M.Sc (2009, with Distinction)**, *University of Cape Town, South Africa*
Advisor: Hussein Suleman
1997–2001 **Cambridge HIGCSE**, *Oshigambo High School, Namibia*

Selected Awards

- 2025 Outstanding Paper Award, ACL 2025 Conference
2022 NSF CAREER Award
2019 Hellman Fellow
2017 Peggy and Peter Preuss Faculty Scholar
2014 Otto Hahn Medal (awarded for PhD dissertation by the Max Planck Society)
2012 Best Paper Award Runner-Up, EMNLP 2012 Conference
2012 Best Paper Award, AKBC Workshop 2012
2006 BSc Honours Scholarship (awarded by the German DAAD-TUCSIN)
2002–2003 Class Medals for Computer Science Courses (awarded to top grade in the class)

Selected Publications

- ACL 2025 Ndapa Nakashole. *Typology-Guided Adaptation in Multilingual Models*. **Outstanding Paper Award.**
NAACL 2024 Yutong Shao, Ndapa Nakashole. *On Linearizing Structured Data in Encoder-Decoder Language Models: Insights from Text-to-SQL*.
EMNLP 2023 Bosung Kim, Ndapa Nakashole. *SYMPTOMIFY: Large-scale Symptom Recognition in post-Vaccine Reports*.
COLING 2022 Khalil Mrini, Harpreet Singh, Franck Dernoncourt, ..., Ndapa Nakashole. *Medical Question Understanding and Answering with Knowledge Grounding and Semantic Self-Supervision*.
ACL 2021 Khalil Mrini, Franck Dernoncourt, Seunghyun Yoon, Trung Bui, Walter Chang, Emilia Farcas, Ndapa Nakashole. *A Gradually Soft Multi-Task and Data-Augmented Approach to Medical Question Understanding*.